

DATA 23700

Project Deliverable 2: Written Proposal

See course schedule for the due date.

The written proposal is the group's first substantive written deliverable for the project. It states the motivating problem or question, describes the dataset the group has chosen, and shows preliminary evidence that the data can meaningfully support the analysis. The Dataset Audit precedes the proposal and is designed to help groups converge on a viable dataset before drafting this document.

What to include

The proposal should include:

- **Motivation:** what problem or question the group wishes to address, and why it's interesting or important. Groups should pose a narrative framing, research question, or hypothesis that can drive the project. Proposing open-ended exploration of a topic is not satisfactory.
 - **Dataset description:** what variables are included in the dataset, where the data came from (provenance), and why the data are suitable for addressing the motivating question. Groups collating multiple data sources should explain how those sources will be integrated.
 - **Visualization:** at least one visualization of the chosen dataset, demonstrating that the data can support the analysis the group intends to do.
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Format and submission

The proposal is a PDF document, up to three pages, single-spaced in 11pt Times New Roman (or similar font) with one-inch margins. Include a title and list all group members as authors.

Groups submit the proposal via Gradescope. Only one group member needs to submit. That submission is credited to the whole group by entering the names of all group members when submitting to Gradescope.

Grading criteria

Written proposals are evaluated on:

- **Motivation:** is the problem or question well framed and non-trivial? Does it support a project of the scope expected?
- **Choice of dataset:** can the described dataset meaningfully support the motivating question? Is the provenance clear?

- **Quality of writing:** is the proposal well written, well organized, and readable?

The proposal may be resubmitted per the standard assignment resubmission policy. See the syllabus for details.